Graphic Design

3D Revolve & 3D Design in Illustrator

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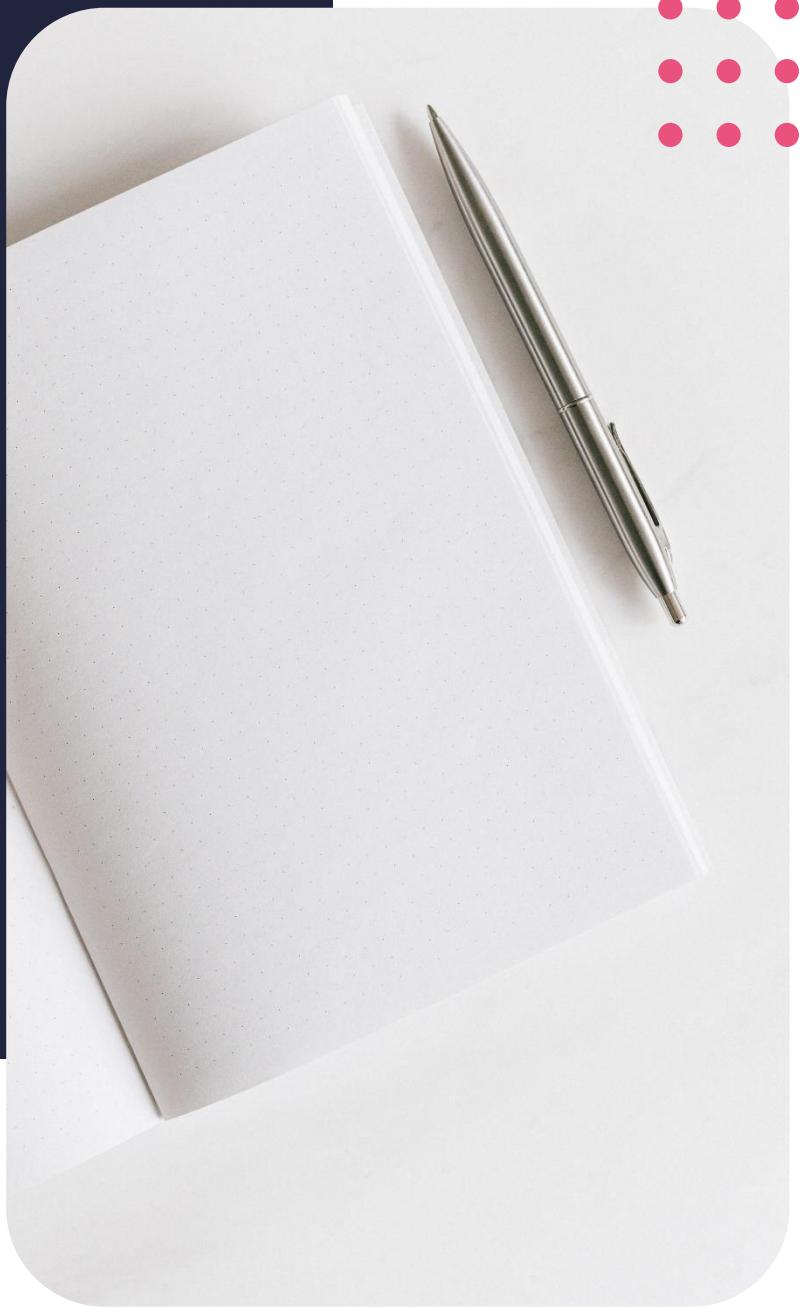


Lesson outcomes

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Lesson outcome 1: Define graphic design
- Lesson outcome 2: When do we use 3D modelling?
- Lesson outcome 3: 3D modelling in illustrator

Introduction

Wine is a favourite for a lot of people, but have you ever considered to create your very own wine label to fit your 3D wine bottle you created digitally? Well, today is your lucky day! We will learn the process of 3Dimensional creation in Illustrator and create our very own wine bottle.

Did you know that wine was first produced over 6000 years ago in the Middle East? The earliest evidence of wine was discovered in Iran. It is believed that the drink was created by accident when yeast encountered stored grapes. This caused the sugars in the grapes to ferment and turn it into alcohol.

Milton Glaser, one of the pioneers of the graphic design industry created designs that you might be quite familiar with. Amongst some of his works, he created the original I love New York logo, the psychedelic Bob Dylan poster as well as the iconic DC logo that was in use for almost 3 decades.

Milton Glaser states that “There are three responses to a piece of design – yes, no and WOW! Wow is the one to aim for.”

Don’t settle for an average looking design but motivate yourself to come up with something unique and captivating.

What is 3D design?

Just to clear up some terms before we dig into our exciting demo a bit later, what is 3d design? I won’t be too long on this topic, as I am sure all of you have a basic understanding of 3D modelling and design. Even though graphic designers are not 3D modellers, we sometimes make use of this in order to create designs. In most cases however, graphic designers would rather create the illusion of 3D space by adding shadows and highlights to make a 2D object seem 3D.

Technically though, everything on your computer screen is 2D, when working on a design that is 3D on your computer, you have the ability to rotate the object around since it consists out of height, width and depth.

Understanding that we work with an object’s height, width and depth we can thus define 3D design as the creation of an item in virtual space such as a product that has three dimensions: its height, width and depth.

The result of this creation is a digital model of your desired design which you can explore in detail.

When do we use 3D modelling?

Designing in 3D has quite a lot of advantages and even though mostly product designers will make use of this feature in a way more advanced way with tools and programs specifically created for 3D modelling, it is good to know the basic ins and outs to 3D modelling as a graphic designer. Not only do you utilise the design programs you work with to their full capacity, but you can also work in relation with product designers and even perhaps become a product designer.

When will we make use of this tool?

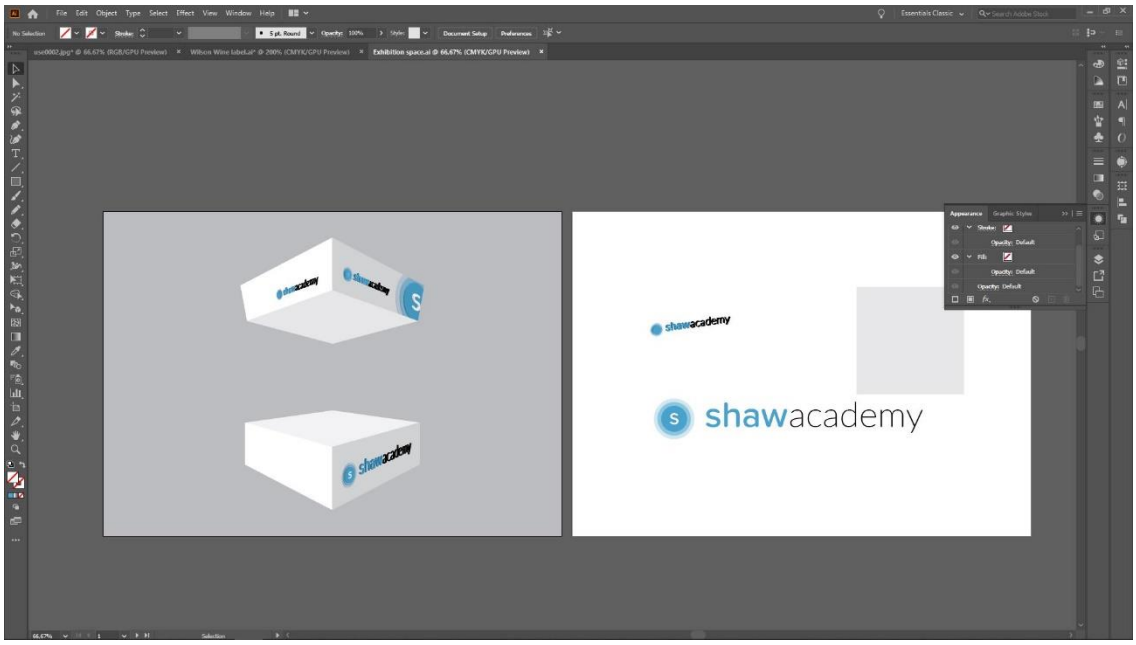
3D design and modelling is more effective in terms of time as well as finances in creating a virtual product, instead of a physical product. Creating a physical prototype of a product is a lot more tedious and time consuming, thus 3d modelling helps the designer and client visualise the product before it is actually physically made.

An example would be the design of an exhibitions space.

If you recall the very first lesson we did, we spoke about the different design careers. One of those careers was an environmental designer. Now, 3D modelling might also be quite handy when you consider environmental design as a career as you don't always have the space or equipment to quickly build a physical mock-up.

3D modelling in Illustrator

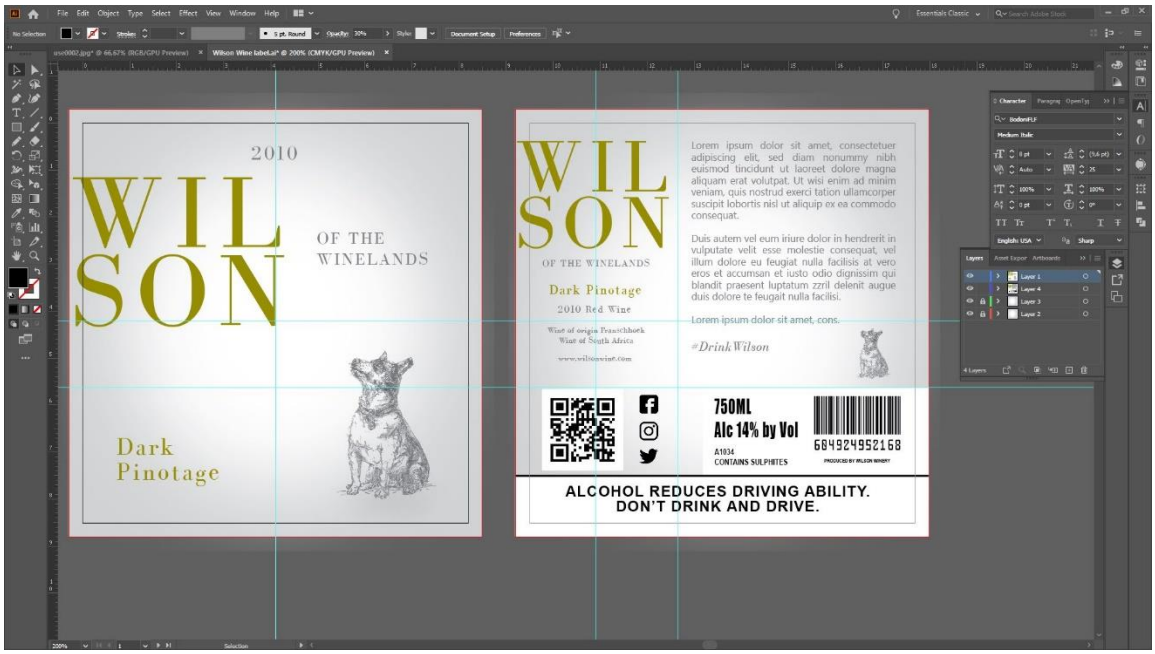
Understanding that 3D modelling and designing is a whole different ball game, we are however able to create very basic 3D designs in Adobe's Illustrator. Kindly note: very basic. And because Illustrator is not a 3D modelling or CAD application, there are some difficulties which I will discuss and show you during our demo.



Please refer to video lesson for demo

So, when deciding which format to use, you need to understand their advantages and disadvantages first. We will firstly look at what a pdf document has to offer.

For our second demo, I will be creating a wine bottle complete with label. You are more than welcome to use the design concepts and ideas that I have, I would however encourage you to come up with your own concepts as this is what graphic design entails.



Please refer to video lesson for demo

Conclusion

Recapping on what we did today. We dig into the world of 3-dimensional design and looked at how we, as graphic designers can utilise it in our careers. Even though Illustrator is not the perfect 3D software, we explored its capabilities in the form of the perspective tool where we created an exhibitions space.

Our second demo entailed the creation of a wine bottle complete with label design as well. And for the exercise, you will be creating your own consumer product with label for this lesson as well. Kindly note that if it is a round product, that you will make use of the 3D revolve tool in illustrator. If it is a rectangular or square product, make use of the perspective tool.

References

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